

Huntr/x Gwi-Ma/Zargon Rules Compendium

FOR ZARGON/GWI-MA'S EYES ONLY!

Do not read this if you are playing as a hero!

This guide contains spoilers!

About Gwi-Ma, the Dungeon Master.....	2
Changes for Zargon/Gwi-Ma's Eyes Only.....	4
Monster Changes.....	4
New Monster Properties.....	4
Zargon/Gwi-Ma Turn Changes (OPTIONAL).....	5
Turn order priority for Monsters (OPTIONAL).....	5
Monster Decision Making Algorithm (OPTIONAL).....	6
Taunting when not using new monster rules.....	6

About Gwi-Ma, the Dungeon Master

This section should only be read if you intend to play the role of the Dungeon Master of this game - Zargon in the original Hero Quest, Gwi-Ma in Huntr/X Quest.

You will control the hidden information of the quests, reveal enemies and obstacles, and set those forces against Huntr/X.

This is not a role meant for someone who gets a thrill in victory or wants to directly compete with the other players: an effective Gwi-Ma who also enjoys playing the role will be someone who finds enjoyment in compelling storytelling and in being an entertainer for other players.

Always remember in this role that your goal is not to win by any means necessary: your true role is that of a storyteller, providing challenge and suspense to make the eventual victory of the heroes more thrilling and eventful. You are the actor getting a thrill from playing a villain who you know will die a glorious and well-deserved death. You are the wrestling heel who is making the whole crowd hate him *just enough to not leave*, so that they will shake the entire stadium with their cheers when you lose the championship title. You take delight from the delight other players find in your setup and unperceived nudging in the direction of eventual victory. This is the true role and challenge of Gwi-Ma.

We have laid out rules in this addendum to help aid in your effort, but always know that you are the controller of this game, and can decide to pivot on any element of these rules and the quests given to you as necessary as long as it is for the purpose of making sure the experience is survivable, yet challenging and entertaining. Your role is not an adversary: it is an entertainer in the masquerade of an adversary.

At times, this freedom and responsibility might mean forsaking some of the automated attack rules to make an encounter survivable. At other times, that might mean unleashing twice the number of enemies that a quest calls for because you think it's too easy for them, only to make some of those enemies dissolve by the power of the Honmoon when you realize you went too far. At other times, it might mean letting a hero ostensibly die, so that you can craft a new custom quest for the remaining heroes to revive or rescue her. Know that the quest book provides a basic foundation for the plot, and you can modify it as much as you see fit for the entertainment of the specific heroes playing at your specific table. Don't ever allow yourself to forget that your main objective is the entertainment of the people at the table, and feel free to take any steps you feel are necessary to enhance whatever they find entertaining in the experience.

For the case of hero death, the Quest Book when complete will provide several scenarios you can choose from for how the death actually plays out in the plot (surprise! It's basically never *actually* death) and how the other heroes can rescue their fallen comrade. Or you can build

your own. Or if your group seems entertained by a darker and grittier game, you can make the death permanent and have the dead hero be replaced by a new recruit who happens to have the same abilities (though perhaps even has to earn their upgrades again: they are a new recruit, after all).

You have the most challenging and ambiguous role in the game, but also the most enjoyable one if you are able to embrace the freedom and responsibility it bears. Good luck.

Changes for Zargon/Gwi-Ma's Eyes Only

The following changes are to how monsters and Gwi-Ma's turn works. Players reading this could spoil the surprise of how the enemy behaves with these changes, so ideally this section is for Gwi-Ma's eyes only.

Monster Changes

Many changes were made for monsters.

New Monster Properties

Type (OPTIONAL): (MINDLESS, TACTICAL, PREDATORY, DOMINATING). These are used by the new Monster Decision Making Algorithm to determine who they should attack. If not using the new decision making system, these properties can be ignored or used as a suggestion.

- **TACTICAL:** Targets the player that dealt the most damage this turn
- **MINDLESS:** Targets the closest player
- **PREDATORY:** Targets the player with the lowest amount of remaining body points
- **DOMINATING:** Targets the player with the lowest amount of remaining mind points

Power Level (OPTIONAL): (Boss, Special, High, Mid, Low, none). This is used to determine the order in which the enemies act during Gwi-Ma's turn. You can choose to ignore this suggestion if not using the new decision making algorithm.

Keywords: Non-spell abilities have been standardized into easier-to-reference Keywords (see Keywords section for more info about which are available). Some are new to this mod, but most come from the core rules or the "Advanced" monster rules from HQ 2020.

Maneuver: Many monsters now have a new "Maneuver" that they can perform when unable to attack their intended target. This allows them to reposition, encourage other enemies to attack, or otherwise be useful and threatening during the turn where normally they would be useless. If not using the new decision making algorithm below, you are free to choose to use this maneuver when it feels appropriate. They can neither move nor perform a normal attack if they choose to Maneuver.

Zargon/Gwi-Ma Turn Changes (OPTIONAL)

This mod has optional rules for replacing Zargon/Gwi-Ma having absolute control over monsters with an algorithm that Gwi-Ma should follow to the best of his ability. This allows the new Taunt status effect to work (see *Status Effects* for more info), as well as provides for some amount of learnable-yet-varied behaviors with monsters. It also provides for the ability to prevent players from being overencumbered with enemies unless the enemies have no less encumbered target.

It is not entirely automatic however: Gwi-Ma will still have to make decisions about breaking ties, for example.

Turn order priority for Monsters (OPTIONAL)

Monsters should act during Gwi-Ma's turn starting from the highest to the lowest power level (Boss, Special, High, Mid, Low, none). In the event of a tie, Gwi-Ma chooses which acts first.

Monster Decision Making Algorithm (OPTIONAL)

This is a set of optional steps for deciding what a monster should do on their turn. Following this allows Gwi-Ma to be more objective, but potentially also predictable in an interesting way that players can learn and attempt to take advantage of tactically over time. If this is all too intimidating, you can fall back to the more open-ended direct control of units.

- **Step 1. (rare) Use of Area Abilities/Spells:**
 - In rare circumstances, a monster has a spell that can affect an area or group of heroes. If this monster has one and can use it, and they have an opportunity to hit more than one hero with it, use it and END TURN. Prioritize the closest grouping of heroes.
- **Step 2. Choose a Target:**
 - Target the closest player that is Taunting them, if any. (See Status Effects)
 - Or else based on creature type (in this test, skip players not in line of sight, or with 2 enemies already attacking them):
 - TACTICAL: Player that dealt the most damage this turn
 - MINDLESS: Closest player
 - PREDATORY: Player with the lowest amount of remaining body points
 - DOMINATING: Player with the lowest amount of remaining mind points
 - Or else target an unblocked player with the least # of current enemies attacking them, choosing the closest one on a tie
- **Step 3. Handle blocked Target:**
 - If the blocking player(s) can be attacked by any means, your target is now the closest blocking player that can be attacked
 - Or else if they cannot be attacked, and you have a "Maneuver" ability, use it as your action instead of attacking. END TURN
 - Or else do the following and END TURN:
 - TACTICAL: Move out of line of sight of as many players as possible
 - OTHER: Get as close to the nearest player as possible
- **Step 4. Attack chosen Target:**
 - If you have an attack that doesn't require you to move, use it and do not move
 - Or else, move and perform your basic attack

Taunting when not using new monster rules

If you are not using the new rules above, you must still honor the Taunt status effect by having any Taunted monsters make every attempt they can to attack the hero who taunted them. If they cannot reach that unit, you can decide whether the monster would fall back to attacking another unit or not.